distinguished government service and was also conferred honorary doctorates from a number of prestigious universities and institutions. The one which must have given him much satisfaction was being elected Honorary Fellow of his alma mater Jesus College, Cambridge.

Deshmukh was a keen student of Sanskrit and translated Kalidasa's 'Meghdoot' into Marathi, publishing a few copies initially for private circulation. Enthused by the favourable response it evoked he was emboldened to bring out a public edition. (His translation had exactly the same number of stanzas and metre as the original work.) From boyhood he had a penchant for versifying, principally in Sanskrit, and occasionally in Marathi, Hindi, Bengali and English. He composed a small poem in Bengali and presented it to Rabindranath Tagore on his birthday. Deshmukh was also a linguist. He was proficient in Sanskrit, Bengali, Gujarati, Urdu, Marathi, Hindi and English. After his marriage to Durgabai he also picked up some Telegu. He also knew French and at the annual meeting of the IMF and the World Bank held in Paris in 1950 he gave a speech in French, something which immediately endeared him to his hosts.

He was also a keen horticulturist and fittingly the citation when Princeton University conferred an honorary degree ended with: 'A botanist by training and a gardener by avocation, he believes, unlike Candide, in cultivating many gardens.'[11] Deshmukh not only retained his scientific interest in plant life but took great delight in nurturing his plants and trees. When he was resident at No. 1 Willingdon Crescent, which later became the residence of Indira Gandhi, he produced fifteen maunds of wheat in half an acre of land—productivity which was very much above the average. Deshmukh also enjoyed the unique distinction of operating a personal current account with the RBI. A letter written by Deshmukh to the manager of the RBI in Hyderabad in June 1976 asking him to credit a cheque to his account with them is on display at the RBI Archives in Pune.

Deshmukh passed away in Hyderabad on October 2, 1982, at the age of eighty-six.